YouTube Reality

YouTube Monetization Requirements

To monetize on YouTube, you need:

Option 1 (Shorts route):

- 1,000 subscribers
- 10 million public Shorts **engaged** views in 90 days

OR

Option 2 (Long-form route):

- 1,000 subscribers
- 4,000 watch hours

In this niche, the Shorts route is the focus.

Once accepted into the YouTube Partner Program (YPP), you earn from:

- The Shorts ad revenue pool
- Long-term channel growth

YouTube is slower than TikTok (in most cases).

But it is far more stable long-term.

Channel Setup & Warm-Up

Channel creation and warming up were covered earlier in this blueprint.

That part matters.

A properly warmed channel in most cases performs significantly better than a cold one.

What Happens on a New Channel?

On a fresh channel:

Shorts can take up to **48 hours** to fully grow.

Don’t panic if views don’t explode immediately.

If your channel is warmed properly, your videos should consistently reach at least:

15,000–30,000 views.

That’s a healthy, minimal baseline.

Can a video explode immediately?

Yes.

But you cannot assume that will happen, especially if you’re just starting.

Consistency Is Heavily Rewarded

If you’re consistently hitting 15–30K per video, the key is:

Post regularly.

No long breaks.

This is not an official rule, but from experience:

YouTube rewards consistent posting far more than irregular posting.

Sometimes it takes one month of consistent posting for the breakout moment to happen.

Audience Targeting

YouTube’s algorithm finds your audience based on your content.

If you’re using:

- English voiceover
- US-relevant topics
- US cultural references

You will naturally attract a high percentage of US viewers.

Applying for Monetization

Once you reach the requirements, you can apply in:

YouTube Studio → Earn tab

The process is straightforward.

After approval, your Shorts become eligible for ad revenue sharing.

RPM Reality

RPM in this niche is not fixed.

It varies heavily based on topic.

My personal RPM range:

$0.14 – $0.27 per 1,000 views

It fluctuates depending on:

- Topic relevance
- Audience location
- Seasonality

More US-focused topics tend to generate higher RPM.

Examples:

- UFC
- Mexican Cartel
- US cities
- Politics
- Current US events

The more US-centric the topic, the better the RPM.

Seasonality

Important:

RPM is usually lowest at the beginning of the year.

Q1 tends to be weaker.

Q4 (especially November–December) is usually the strongest.

So don’t judge your earning potential based on January/February performance.

One More Important Reality

YouTube Shorts monetization is volume-based.

This is not long-form YouTube with $5–$20 RPM.

You scale through:

- Multiple videos
- Consistency

It compounds over time.